

The Noble Tantra of the Secret Wheel of the Four Activities of Mañjuśrī

Āryamañjuśrīkarmacatuṣṭacakraḡuhyatantra · Toh 838 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་འཇམ་དཔལ་ལས་བཞུགས་ལོ་ལོ་སང་བའི་རྒྱ།

This text is the Ārya-mañjuśrī-karma-catuṣṭaya-cakra-ḡuhyatantra, known in Tibetan as the Phakpa Jampal Lé Zhi Khorlo Sangwé Gyü, or "The Noble Secret Wheel of the Four Activities of Mañjuśrī," catalogued as Toh 838 in the Kangyur. It belongs to the class of tantric literature associated with Mañjuśrī, the bodhisattva of wisdom, and is structured as a series of chapters combining ritual instruction, wrathful invocations, and praises addressed to wisdom deities embodying fierce, transformative power. The excerpt given here, drawn from its concluding portion, depicts a fearsome deity adorned with symbols of impermanence and dissolution—fresh human and tiger skins—whose worship culminates in the practitioner's realization of non-duality with the deity. As a ḡuhyatantra, or "secret tantra," the text concerns esoteric methods for accomplishing the four traditional activities (pacifying, increasing, controlling, and subjugating) through visualization, mantra, and ritual identification with wrathful forms of enlightened wisdom. Its closing lines mark the completion of the fourteenth chapter and the tantra's overall arrangement, situating it among the Kangyur's collection of tantric scriptures tied to the Mañjuśrī cycle.

Its face and eyes, fierce and wrathful, opened wide,
clad above in fresh, moist human skin,
adorned in body with a fresh, moist tiger skin,
bearing such a form, blazing in its array—
homage to the greatly wondrous, the marvelous one!

Having offered this praise, they became non-dual.

This concludes the fourteenth chapter from the noble tantra, The Secret Wheel of the Four Activities.

From the noble tantra, The Secret Wheel of the Four Activities: the sequential arrangement of the concluding tantra is complete.

Translator's Notes

- The final lines are colophon material rather than narrative prose; they mark the end of a chapter and then the end of a further, "later" (concluding) portion of the tantra called rgyud phyi ma. The precise referent of rgyud phyi ma ("later/subsequent tantra") — whether a

distinct appended tantra or a concluding section of the same work — is not fully certain from this fragment alone.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.